

9 Normative Ethics Background Quiz ANS

1. What is a normative statement?

- A) A judgment about what ought to be done or valued
- B) A measurement with no evaluative content
- C) A prediction of model latency
- D) A description of historical frequency only

ANS: A) A judgment about what ought to be done or valued

2. What is descriptive ethics?

- A) A theory of what is morally right
- B) The study of what people actually believe and do regarding morality
- C) A command that everyone must follow
- D) A method for maximizing utility

ANS: B) The study of what people actually believe and do regarding morality

3. What does consequentialism evaluate most directly?

- A) Whether an act follows a rule regardless of effects
- B) Only the actor's character
- C) The outcomes or consequences of actions
- D) Only legal compliance

ANS: C) The outcomes or consequences of actions

4. What does deontology emphasize?

- A) Total wellbeing only
- B) Observed preferences only
- C) Market efficiency
- D) Duties, rights, and constraints on action

ANS: D) Duties, rights, and constraints on action

5. What is virtue ethics primarily concerned with?

- A) Character traits and what a good person would be or do
- B) Only numerical outcomes
- C) Only universal legal rules
- D) Strategic equilibria

ANS: A) Character traits and what a good person would be or do

6. What is utilitarianism?

- A) The view that intentions alone determine rightness
- B) The view that actions should maximize overall wellbeing
- C) The view that laws can never be criticized
- D) The view that preferences cannot be compared

ANS: B) The view that actions should maximize overall wellbeing

7. What is an agent-relative duty?

- A) A duty applying identically to everyone regardless of relationship
- B) A prediction about behavior
- C) A duty whose force depends on the agent's relationship or commitments
- D) A statistical regularity

ANS: C) A duty whose force depends on the agent's relationship or commitments

8. What is a moral right?

- A) A guarantee of maximum happiness
- B) A personal taste
- C) A market price
- D) A justified claim that places duties or limits on how others may act

ANS: D) A justified claim that places duties or limits on how others may act

9. What is the doctrine of double effect used to analyze?

- A) Actions with both intended good effects and foreseen harmful side effects
- B) Only actions with no consequences
- C) Machine-learning overfitting
- D) Economic inflation

ANS: A) Actions with both intended good effects and foreseen harmful side effects

10. What is the difference between doing and allowing harm?

- A) There is no possible moral distinction
- B) Some moral theories treat actively causing harm differently from permitting it
- C) Allowing harm is always worse
- D) Doing harm never matters

ANS: B) Some moral theories treat actively causing harm differently from permitting it

11. What is contractualism?

- A) Maximizing total utility
- B) Following personal preference
- C) Evaluating principles by whether they could be reasonably rejected by affected persons
- D) Obeying existing contracts only

ANS: C) Evaluating principles by whether they could be reasonably rejected by affected persons

12. What is moral particularism?

- A) All cases are settled by one formula
- B) Only outcomes matter
- C) Moral reasons never vary by context
- D) Moral judgment may depend on context rather than fixed universal principles

ANS: D) Moral judgment may depend on context rather than fixed universal principles

13. What is moral realism?

- A) The view that at least some moral claims are objectively true
- B) The view that morality is only emotion
- C) The view that ethics is meaningless
- D) The view that law defines all morality

ANS: A) The view that at least some moral claims are objectively true

14. What is moral relativism?

- A) All moral truths are universal
- B) Moral truth or justification can depend on a culture or framework
- C) Consequences never matter
- D) Every disagreement has one obvious answer

ANS: B) Moral truth or justification can depend on a culture or framework

15. What is the naturalistic fallacy commonly associated with?

- A) Inferring facts from values
- B) Rejecting all natural facts
- C) Inferring what ought to be solely from what is
- D) Using probability in ethics

ANS: C) Inferring what ought to be solely from what is

16. What is the is-ought gap?

- A) A gap between two utility values
- B) A difference between law and policy
- C) A disagreement among voters
- D) The point that purely descriptive premises do not by themselves yield normative conclusions

ANS: D) The point that purely descriptive premises do not by themselves yield normative conclusions

17. What is reflective equilibrium?

- A)** Adjusting principles and judgments until they fit together coherently
- B)** Maximizing one fixed equation
- C)** Following first intuitions without revision
- D)** Replacing ethics with surveys

ANS: A) Adjusting principles and judgments until they fit together coherently

18. Why are thought experiments used in ethics?

- A)** To provide legal precedent
- B)** To isolate morally relevant features and test principles or intuitions
- C)** To guarantee consensus
- D)** To collect model-training data only

ANS: B) To isolate morally relevant features and test principles or intuitions

19. What is moral uncertainty?

- A)** Uncertainty about empirical facts only
- B)** A rejection of moral reasoning
- C)** Uncertainty about which moral theory or principles are correct
- D)** A guarantee that all theories agree

ANS: C) Uncertainty about which moral theory or principles are correct

20. Why is normative ethics relevant to AI design?

- A)** AI systems make no decisions
- B)** Technical accuracy settles every value question
- C)** Only developers are affected
- D)** Design choices can distribute benefits, harms, rights, and responsibilities among people

ANS: D) Design choices can distribute benefits, harms, rights, and responsibilities among people